

B. 1.1. Complete the following sentences on the basis of what you have studied

- (a) India's glory is that it
- (b) The charge against India is that
- (c) We dare not change what
- (d) Our ancestors set a limit to our indulgences because
- (e) Our forefathers did not invent machinery because

Answer:

(a) is immovable, (b) her people are uncivilized, ignorant and stolid, (c) we have tested and found true on the anvil of experience, (d) more we indulge in our passions, the more unbridled they become, (e) if we invented machinery, we would become slaves and lose our moral fibre.

B. 1.2. Answer the following questions briefly

Question 1.

How is Indian civilization different from European civilization?

Answer:

European civilization is guided by the writings of Greece and Rome, which no longer exist in their former glory. But Indian civilization is steady. It follows the path that our forefathers tested on the anvil of experience and found true and durable. Indian civilization needs no external guide.

Question 2.

Why does Gandhiji say that 'mind is a restless bird'? What makes the mind restless?

Answer:

Gandhiji says that mind is a restless bird because it is never satisfied. The more it gets the more it wants.

Question 3.

Why did our ancestors dissuade us from luxuries and pleasures? Did they do the right thing?

Answer:

Our ancestors dissuaded us from luxuries and pleasures because they do not lead to happiness. The more one indulges in them, the more dissatisfied one becomes. Our ancestors did the right thing because we find that even the rich people are unhappy, and many poor are happy. In fact happiness is a mental condition. It does not depend on wealth and possessions.

Question 4.

Why according to Gandhi, have we stuck with the same kind of plough as existed thousands of years ago? Should we do the same thing even today?

Answer:

According to Gandhiji we stuck to the plough that existed thousands of years ago because we did not want to indulge in competition. We were content with our simple ways of life. Health and happiness come through the use of our hands and feet. But I don't think it will be right to do the same thing today. We cannot feed our one billion population if we used the same old plough today. Besides, our very existence in the modern world would be almost impossible.

Question 5.

How did our ancestors view large cities? Why were they satisfied

Answer:

Our ancestors could foresee the vices that are bound to flourish in big cities. They knew that gangs of thieves and robbers, prostitution and other vices flourish in big cities, and the rich rob the poor. They were, therefore, satisfied with small villages.

Question 6.

How did our ancestors enjoy true 'Home Rule'?

Answer:

Our ancestors followed their simple occupations and lived independently. Thus they enjoyed true Home Rule.

B. 2. Answer the following questions briefly

Question 1.

What, according to the author, is modern civilization?

Answer:

According to Gandhiji modern civilization is the worship of materialism and violence and brutality.

Question 2.

What did the author convey to the countrymen about dealing with modern civilization?

Answer:

Gandhiji points out that the tendency of Indian civilization is to elevate the moral being, but that of the western civilization is to propagate immorality. He asked his countrymen to cling to their civilization, but shun the modern civilization at all costs.

Question 3.

What is the distinguishing characteristic of modern civilization?

Answer:

According to Gandhiji indefinite multiplicity of human wants is the distinguishing characteristic of modern civilization.

Question 4.

The author perceived danger from modern civilization.

How?

Answer:

Gandhiji believed that the inventions of modern civilization were too maddening to resist. They could give. If they are not resisted, we would barter our permanent good for momentary pleasure.

Question 5.

What does author prefer to materialism?

Answer:

The author prefers spiritualism to materialism.

Question 6.

What does our civilization depend on ?

Answer:

Our civilization depends not on multiplying our demands; but on restricting them.

Question 7.

What is civilization in the real sense of the term?

Answer:

In the real sense of the term, civilization means deliberate, voluntary restriction of wants.

Answer Questions

Question 1.

'I BELIEVE that the civilization India has evolved is not to be beaten in the world.' What does Gandhi mean by this statement? Do you subscribe to his views?

Answer:

Gandhiji is of the firm view that the civilization India has evolved is founded on firm grounds. Our ancestors tested it on the anvil of their experience and found it to be true. The civilization of India has withstood the test of time. Egypt was a great and powerful civilization. It has lost its glory. It no longer exists. Same is the case with the great Roman and Greek civilization. They have lost their former glory. Japan has westernised. The people of Europe are inspired by Greek and Roman writers, and believe that they will be able to steer clear of the mistakes those people made. But Gandhiji does not hope that they will be able to do so.

About the Indian civilization, Gandhiji says that people of the world think that the people of India are not willing to adapt themselves to new ideas. But Gandhiji does not consider it a fault. It is our merit because our civilization is perfect and lasting. We need nobody's guidance. I subscribe to Gandhiji's viewpoint. The civilization of India is thousands of years old, and is still going strong. The philosophy of our ancestors propounded is ingrained in our blood. But, I think, Indian civilization is flexible. It can easily assimilate ideas from other civilizations, and still can march ahead with great vigour. That is the beauty and merit of Indian civilization.